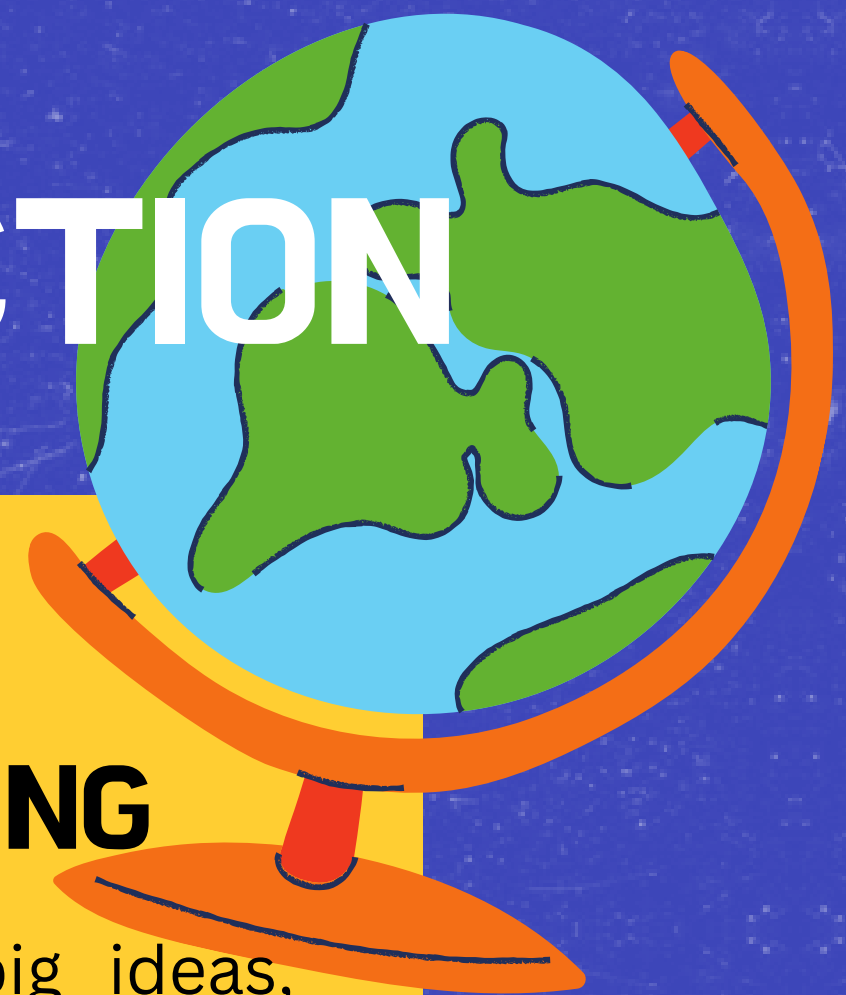




INTRODUCTION



INNOVATE-X PRESENTS: PROJECT DESIGN & PLANNING

Welcome to a competition where your big ideas, strategic thinking, and planning skills are more important than your code. In this event, teams will tackle a real-world problem statement and design a complete project plan from concept to execution—without writing a single line of code.

This is your chance to step into the shoes of a Product Manager, a Systems Architect, and a Team Lead. Prove you can not only come up with a great idea but also create a realistic plan to make it happen.

ROUND 1 THE BLUEPRINT



Objective: To create a solid foundation for a project by defining its core concept, target user, and technical approach.

Task: Teams are given a problem statement and must complete a guided form covering the project's vision, user persona, core features, tech stack, and potential risks.



Example in Action ("SkillSwap"): A team conceptualized "SkillSwap," a campus app for bartering skills. They defined a user persona ("Rohan, the engineering student"), outlined features like profiles and search, and identified the risk of low user adoption.

Judgement Parameters

- 1. Clarity of Vision:** How well is the problem understood and the mission defined?
- 2. Depth of User Understanding:** Is the user persona realistic? Are the features user-centric?
- 3. Technical Feasibility:** Is the chosen tech stack logical and well-justified for the project?
- 4. Critical Thinking:** How well are success metrics and risks identified?



ROUND 2: THE CURVEBALL



Objective: To test adaptability, prioritization, and strategic decision-making under pressure.

Task: Teams face a sudden, unexpected constraint (e.g., a massive budget cut) and must adapt their original plan. They have to decide which one or two features are absolutely essential for a Minimum Viable Product (MVP).



Example in Action ("SkillSwap"): Faced with a budget cut, the "SkillSwap" team strategically chose to build only the "Skill Profile Creation" feature, arguing that building a user base is the most critical first step for a marketplace app.

Judgement Parameters



- 1. Strategic Justification:** How strong and logical is the argument for the chosen features?
 - 2. User-Centric Detail:** Is the refined user flow for the new MVP clear and well-thought-out?
 - 3. Realism & Consequence Awareness:** Does the team understand and acknowledge the trade-offs of their decision?
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ROUND 3

THE GAME PLAN



Objective: To assess a team's ability to create a realistic execution plan and effectively communicate their strategy.

Task: Finalists get 30 minutes to create a detailed "Game Plan," including a work breakdown structure, a 4-week timeline, and a risk assessment matrix. They then deliver a 3-minute pitch and face a 2-minute Q&A from the judges.

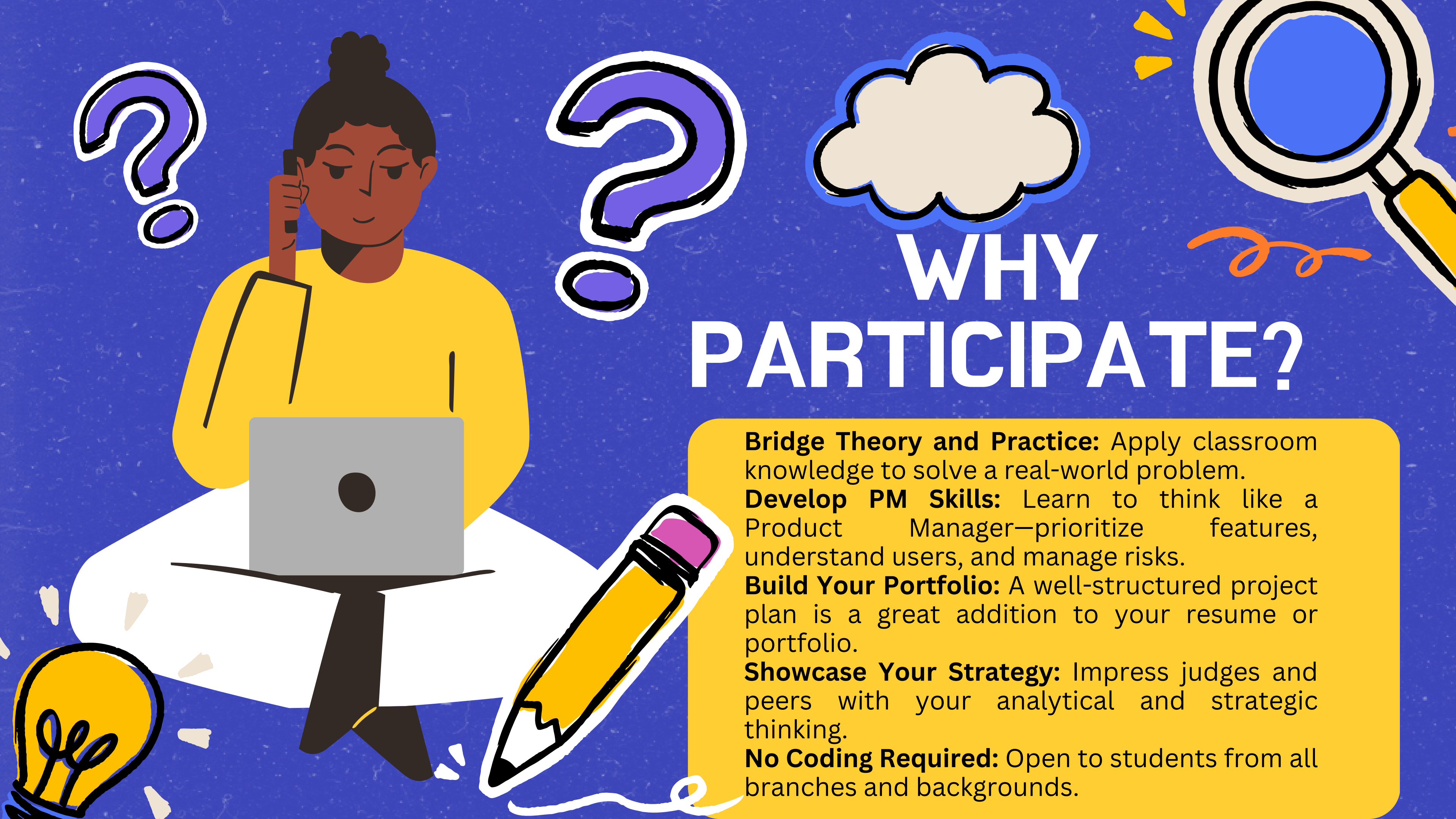
Example in Action ("SkillSwap"): The team created a 4-week timeline, identified key risks like low-quality profiles, and confidently defended their plan in a live Q&A with the judges.



Judgement Parameters

- 1. Plan Coherence & Realism:** Is the timeline and task breakdown logical and achievable?
- 2. Risk Management:** Are the identified risks meaningful and the mitigation plans practical?
- 3. Communication & Defensibility:** How clear, persuasive, and confident is the pitch and Q&A performance?



An illustration on a dark blue background. On the left, a person with dark skin and hair in a bun, wearing a yellow shirt, sits at a white desk with a laptop. They are holding a black phone to their ear. Above them are two large purple question marks. To the right of the person is a large white cloud with a blue outline. Further right is a magnifying glass with a blue lens and a yellow handle. In the bottom left corner is a yellow lightbulb. In the bottom center is a large yellow pencil with a pink eraser. The text 'WHY PARTICIPATE?' is written in large white letters on the right side.

WHY PARTICIPATE?

Bridge Theory and Practice: Apply classroom knowledge to solve a real-world problem.

Develop PM Skills: Learn to think like a Product Manager—prioritize features, understand users, and manage risks.

Build Your Portfolio: A well-structured project plan is a great addition to your resume or portfolio.

Showcase Your Strategy: Impress judges and peers with your analytical and strategic thinking.

No Coding Required: Open to students from all branches and backgrounds.